

VIOLET HOUR

A STORY OF SHADOWS, LEGACY,
AND THE TRUTH BURIED IN SILENCE.

04: The House That Remembers

— 記憶する家 —

REIKA TENDO
天道 麗華

TENNOJI ACADEMY
STUDENT COUNCIL PRESIDENT

TENNOJI ARCHIVES



1
9
4
7

— EPISODE FOUR —

天ノ学院
TENNOJI
ACADEMY

EST.1947



HINOMORI ACADEMY
STUDENT COUNCIL OFFICE
MORNING

PRESIDENT
TENDO.

A FORMAL MEMO
FROM ADMINISTRATION.

REIKA TENDO

18

THE READER OF
THE PAST



THE OLD WING
IS SCHEDULED FOR
RENOVATION.

CATALOGUE ITS
REMAINING CONTENTS
BEFORE DESIGNATED
ROOMS ARE SEALED
FOR DEMOLITION.

HINOMORI ACADEMY
OFFICE OF FACILITIES MANAGEMENT
MEMORANDUM

TO: STUDENT COUNCIL PRESIDENT
REIKA TENDO

SUBJECT: OLD WING RENOVATION — CONTENTS CATALOGING

This is to inform you that the Old Wing of Hinomori Academy is scheduled for comprehensive renovation.

In accordance with institutional procedures, the following rooms will be sealed for demolition on the dates indicated below.

You are hereby instructed to catalogue all remaining contents within the Old Wing prior to the sealing of designated areas. Submit inventory logs to the Administration Office by the deadline specified.

Your cooperation is essential to ensure proper records retention and asset management.

[Signature]
DIRECTOR, FACILITIES MANAGEMENT



HINOMORI ACADEMY
COMMITTED TO TRADITION.
BOUND BY DUTY.

INSTITUTIONAL PRESERVATION
IS NOT MERELY MAINTENANCE.
IT IS CONTINUITY.

ピキッ。
(CREAK)

1

THE SCHOOL LIBRARY.
THAT SAME AFTERNOON.

REIKA TENDO
18.

BEFORE THE OLD WING,
SHE RESEARCHES
ITS DOCUMENTED
HISTORY FIRST.

HORIKOSHI-SAN.
THE LIBRARIAN.
HER WATCHFULNESS
READS AS MORE THAN
PROFESSIONAL.

2

THE SPINE
BEARS NO LABEL.
THE PAGES
HOLD NO PAST—
ONLY A FUTURE.

DATE:
FIVE YEARS
FROM NOW.

AUTHOR:
TENDO

A NAME
THAT DOES NOT
BELONG TO ANY
LIVING RELATIVE.

3

DATE:
FIVE YEARS FROM NOW

AUTHOR:
TENDO

In twenty minutes, a girl
in a white uniform will stand
in the old wing, in the third
classroom on the left.
She will place her right hand
against the wall beneath
the window.
The paint will be cool.
She will feel the faint ridge
beneath her palm.
She will not know why
it matters.
But it does.
It always has.
It always will.

PRESENT TENSE.
PRESENT ACTION.
NOT MEMORY—
PREDICTION.
NOT POSSIBLE—
INEVITABLE.

4

HER HAND
CLOSES GENTLY.

THE BOOK
LEAVES REIKA'S
GRIP WITHOUT
RESISTANCE.

THIS IS NOT
THE FIRST TIME.

IT WILL NOT BE
THE LAST.

THE LIBRARIAN
KNOWS THE COST
OF FUTURE WORDS.

SHE REMOVES
WHAT SHOULD
NEVER BE READ.



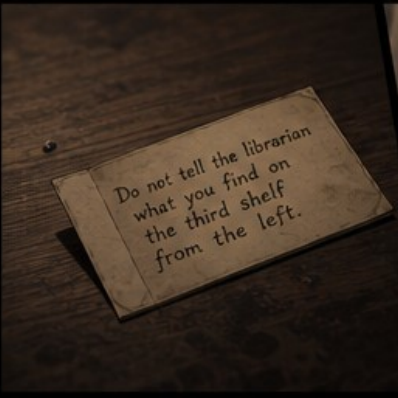
HORIKOSHI-SAN...

WHAT WAS
THAT BOOK?
CAREFULLY.



SOME BOOKS
REMEMBER WHAT
HASN'T HAPPENED
YET.

IT'S BETTER
IF THEY STAY
CLOSED.



Do not tell the librarian
what you find on
the third shelf
from the left.



スッ...



フッ...



...I SEE.

THERE'S NO
NEED TO KNOW
ANY MORE THAN
THAT.

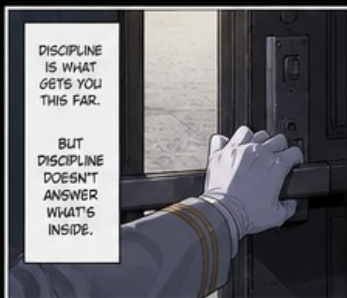


MINUTES AGO,
I'D TAPED THE
SIGN MYSELF.

NOW COMES
THE PART
THAT HAS NO
PROCEDURE
FOR.

THE SEAM
BETWEEN
WHAT WE
MAINTAIN...

...AND WHAT
WE BURY.



DISCIPLINE
IS WHAT
GETS YOU
THIS FAR.

BUT
DISCIPLINE
DOESN'T
ANSWER
WHAT'S
INSIDE.



THIS IS MY
FIRST OFFICIAL
ENTRY.

NOT OUT OF
CURIOSITY.

OUT OF
AUTHORITY.

AND THAT
CHANGES
THE KIND OF
TRUTH THAT
CAN FOLLOW
YOU HOME.



PERFECT
POSTURE.

PERFECT
COMPOSURE.

EXHAUSTION
IS A PRIVATE
MATTER.



I'M NOT
HERE AS
A STUDENT
ANYMORE.

I'M HERE
AS THE
RECORD.



WHATEVER
WE FIND
TODAY...

...IT WILL
FIND ITS
WAY INTO
OUR FILES.



ONE
PUSH.

AND THE
INSTITUTION
KNOWS I'VE
BEEN HERE.



SOME DOORS
DON'T CLOSE
BEHIND YOU.

THEY
CLOSE ON
YOU.



REIKA TENDO.

STUDENT COUNCIL
PRESIDENT.

ON RECORD.

ON PURPOSE.

REIKA TENDO

18, THE READER OF THE PAST

...THIS
ROOM.

IT'S BEEN
SEALED FOR
YEARS.

天道麗香

過去を読む者

SHE WASN'T PREPARED
FOR ABSENCE.

SUBJECTIVE POV:

HER GIFT DOES NOT SHOW
HER WHAT WAS.

ONLY THE SHAPE OF WHAT
NO LONGER IS.

NOT A MEMORY.

A HOLE.

WITH NO BOTTOM.

SOME ERASURES
ARE SO COMPLETE,
EVEN THE PAST
CANNOT REMEMBER.

SHE ERACHES
FOR NOTHING.

AND THE SILENCE
BREAKS HER.

THE TRUTH WASN'T BURIED.
IT WAS UNMADE.



AMATSUKA
ARCHIVE WING
RESTRICTED

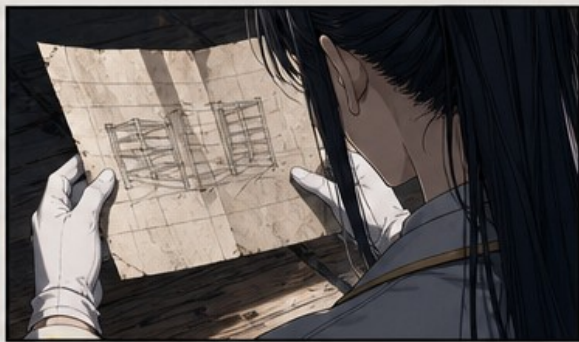
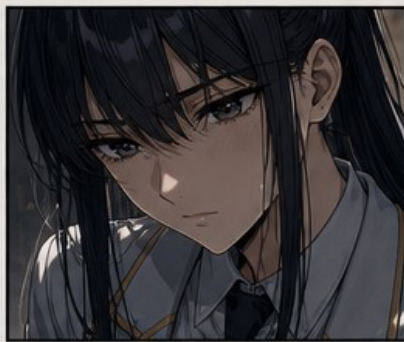
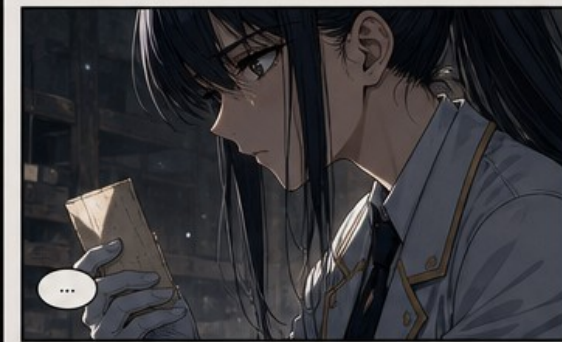
[illegible][illegible][illegible]

*OLD-WING STORAGE ROOM
CONTINUOUS*

*SECTION 7-B
SHELVING UNIT
(REMOVED)*

*7-B
(REMOVED)*

<i>INVENTORY LOG - SECTION 7</i>		
<i>ITEM</i>	<i>DESCRIPTION</i>	<i>STATUS</i>



SOMEONE KNEW.
DECADES AGO.

THEY KNEW I WOULD
STAND HERE.

THEY KNEW I WOULD
WANT THIS.



SOMEONE KNEW.
DECADES AGO.

THEY KNEW I WOULD
STAND HERE.

THEY KNEW I WOULD
WANT THIS.



SOMEONE KNEW.
DECADES AGO.

THEY KNEW I WOULD
STAND HERE.

THEY KNEW I WOULD
WANT THIS.

I WILL NOT WRITE THIS DOWN.

NOT EVERYTHING SERVES THE RECORD.

I WILL NOT WRITE THIS DOWN.

NOT EVERYTHING SERVES THE RECORD.



UNRELATED
ERRAND.

UNWANTED
KNOWLEDGE.

FILED.

PRINCIPAL

YES, THE OLD WING
RENOVATION IS
STILL ON SCHEDULE.

NO, THE STRUCTURAL
SAFETY CONCERNS
HAVEN'T CHANGED.

WE'LL NEED TO CLEAR
THE ADJACENT LOT
BEFORE PHASE TWO.

SUBJECTIVE POV:
READER OF TRUTH
[OVERHEARD FRAGMENT]

PRESENT TRUTH: CONVERSATION SUBTEXT
STATED REASON: STRUCTURAL SAFETY
REAL DRIVER: FINANCIAL OPPORTUNITY
TRIGGER: PRIVATE DEVELOPER INQUIRY
[ACQUIRE ADJACENT LAND]
↓
ADMIN RESPONSE: ACCOMMODATING
[OPPORTUNITY DRESSED AS SAFETY CONCERN]

NOT ABOUT
SAFETY.

NEVER WAS.

ANOTHER LAYER.

ANOTHER LIE.

CATALOGUE
UPDATED.

EMOTION:
NONE.

FEET FORWARD.

MIND FOREVER.

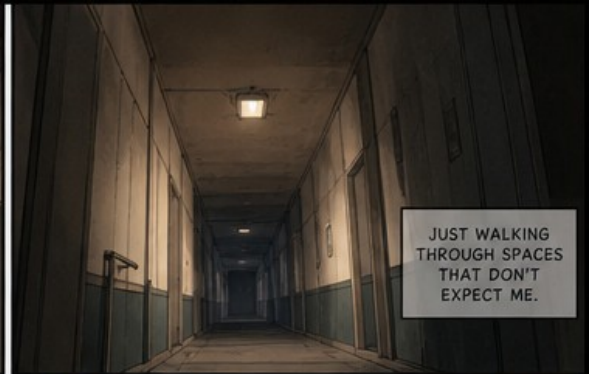


THE OLD WING
GROUND FLOOR

11:47 PM



I WASN'T
LOOKING FOR
ANYTHING.



JUST WALKING
THROUGH SPACES
THAT DON'T
EXPECT ME.



PEOPLE
ARE
COMPLICATED.



BASEMENT
ACCESS
RESTRICTED



BUT THIS...



THIS IS THE
FIRST TIME
SOMETHING
THAT ISN'T
A PERSON...

...HAS MADE
THE WORLD
BEND TOWARD
IT.



MY HAND
FOUND
GRANDPA'S
PENDANT.

LIKE IT KNEW
BEFORE I DID.



SOME DOORS
AREN'T MEANT
TO BE OPENED.

SOME ARE
MEANT TO BE
REMEMBERED.



THE EAST
WING. SECOND
FLOOR. THREE
SHELVES. GONE.

NO RECORD
OF REMOVAL.
NO TRANSFER.
JUST...GONE.

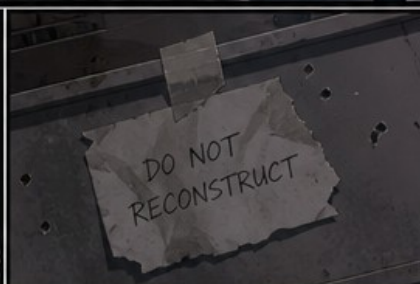
I OVERHEARD
THE DEVELOPERS,
THREE WEEKS AGO.
THEIR TIMELINE.
THEIR LANGUAGE.

"THE STRUCTURE
IS BEYOND
FEASIBLE."
"START FRESH."
"MAKE IT
DISAPPEAR."



AND THIS
WAS LEFT
BEHIND.

TAPED INSIDE
THE CABINET
FRAME.



THEY THINK
THIS PLACE IS
JUST OLD
CONCRETE.

BUT THEY'RE
NOT TRYING TO
REPAIR IT.

THEY'RE TRYING
TO ERASE IT.



MISSING
SHELVES

DEVELOPER
CONVERSATION

TIMELINE
MATCH

INTENTIONAL

LONG-PLANNED



THREE WEEKS AGO.

THE
PERMITS
WILL COME
THROUGH.

ONCE THE
OLD SCHOOL
IS GONE, THE
LOT DOUBLES
IN VALUE.

HISTORY
DOESN'T
PKY.

FIVE YEARS AGO.

THE OLD
FOUNDATION
REPORTS...

...WE
DON'T NEED
TO INCLUDE
THEM.

IF IT'S NOT
IN THE PLAN,
IT DOESN'T
EXIST.



.....



SOMEONE WANTS THIS BUILDING GONE.
AND HAS WANTED IT GONE FOR A VERY LONG TIME.



THE OLD-WING
CLASSROOM.

CONTINUOUS
BOTH PHONES.

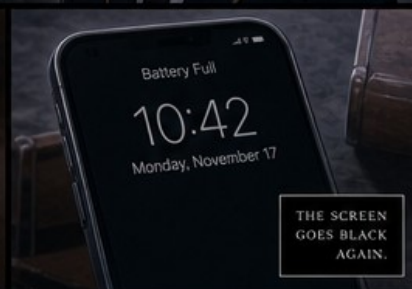
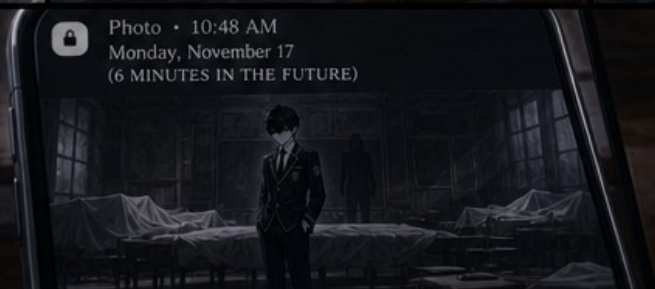
VELETH CUT.

THE DUST SHEETS'
FOLDS SHIFT AT
A WRONG ANGLE.
THE ROOM'S AIR
ADMITS NO SUCH
MOVEMENT.

THEN—
KAI'S PHONE
FLASHES ONCE.



A NOTIFICATION.
NEITHER OF THEM
TAPPED.



THE SCREEN
GOES BLACK
AGAIN.

REIKA TENDO

Third-Year,
Disciplinary
Committee
Excellence in
Etiquette and
Observation.

Emotionally
Unyielding.



NEITHER SAYS ANYTHING
FOR A LONG BEAT.

KAI MORI

Third-Year,
Strategic
Oversight
Committee
Excellence in
Logic and
Control.

Emotionally
Detached.



THE DUST SHEETS
SHIFT WRONG.

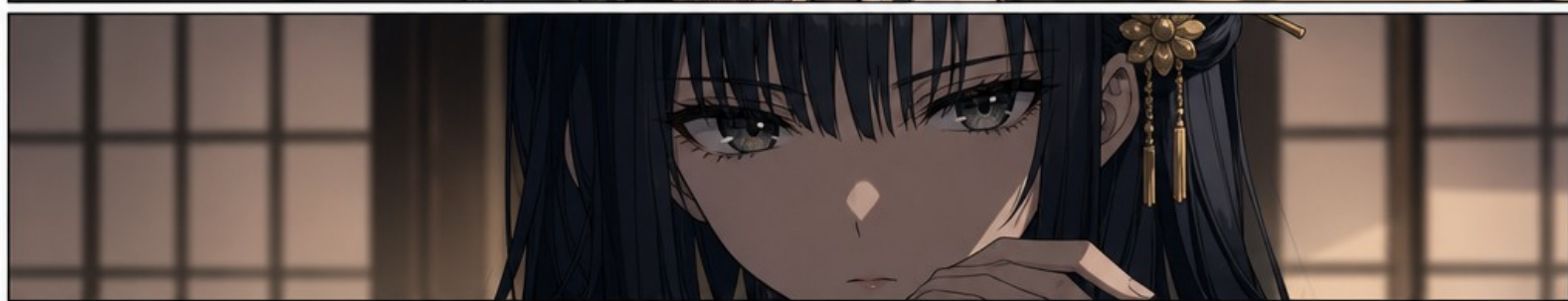
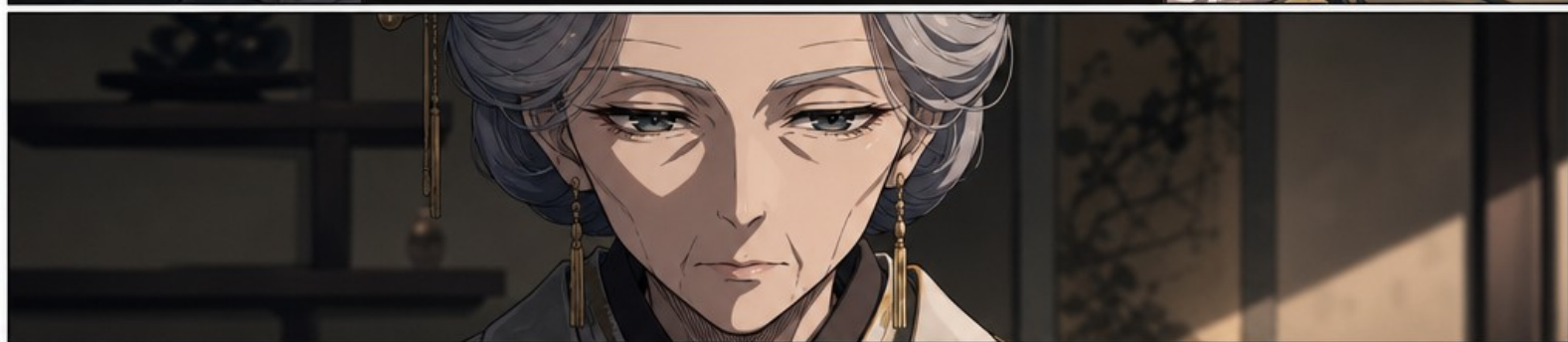
THE NOTIFICATION
APPEARS.



HER ABSENCE IN THE
FUTURE-PHOTOGRAPH—
THE QUIET, TERRIFYING
CENTER OF THE FRAME.



THE TENDO
FAMILY HOME.
THAT EVENING.



TENDO FAMILY HOME
18:42



A LOCKED CABINET.

REIKA HAD NEVER
SEEN IT OPENED.
NOT ONCE IN
EIGHTEEN YEARS.

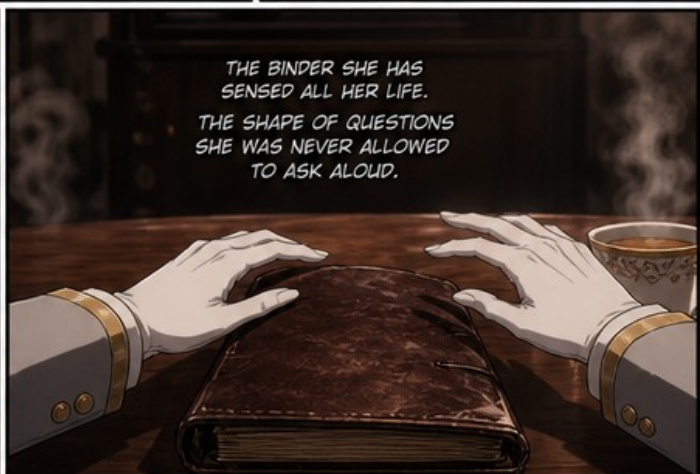


YOUR GREAT-GRANDMOTHER
KEPT THIS.
I WAS TOLD NEVER TO SHOW
IT TO YOU UNTIL YOU ASKED
THE RIGHT QUESTION.

TODAY, APPARENTLY,
YOU ASKED IT.



THE BINDER SHE HAS
SENSED ALL HER LIFE.
THE SHAPE OF QUESTIONS
SHE WAS NEVER ALLOWED
TO ASK ALOUD.



REIKA TENDO.

EIGHTEEN YEARS OLD.

HEIR TO A LEGACY
BUILT ON SILENCE
AND DUTY.

SHE HAS SPENT
HER LIFE LEARNING
EVERYTHING—
EXCEPT THE TRUTH
OF WHERE SHE
COMES FROM.



TODAY,
THE SILENCE
BREAKS.



SORA MINABE — 16.
THE READER OF THE FUTURE.

THE NEIGHBOURHOOD SENTŌ.
EVENING. THE SPECIFIC QUIET
OF A PUBLIC BATH AT AN
OFF-PEAK HOUR.

HIS REFLECTION.
FRACTURED ACROSS
THE WATER'S SLOW-
MOVING SURFACE.

A TRUTH NOT YET
ASSEMBLED.

IN THE STEAM'S
SOFT SILENCE,

SORA AND THE PAST
HE HAS NOT YET
READ.

静寂

HEIRLOOM.
REMOVED FROM BENEATH
HIS SHIRT FOR ONCE.

EXAMINING IT PROPERLY
FOR THE FIRST TIME
IN YEARS.

THE ENGRAVING
IS WORN.
BARELY VISIBLE
IN THE LOW LIGHT.

HE DOES NOT YET
UNDERSTAND WHAT
HE IS LOOKING AT.

HE ONLY KNOWS,
WITH THE SAME
WORDLESS
CERTAINTY HIS GIFT
HAS GIVEN
HIM ABOUT
WORSE THINGS,

THAT THIS SMALL
OBJECT BELONGED
TO SOMEONE WHO
KNEW SOMETHING
ABOUT THE OLD
WING'S BASEMENT.

AND THAT HE HAS
BEEN CARRYING IT,
UNEXAMINED,
FOR YEARS.

1.
HER BARE HAND.
DELIBERATE CONTACT.
CHOSEN.



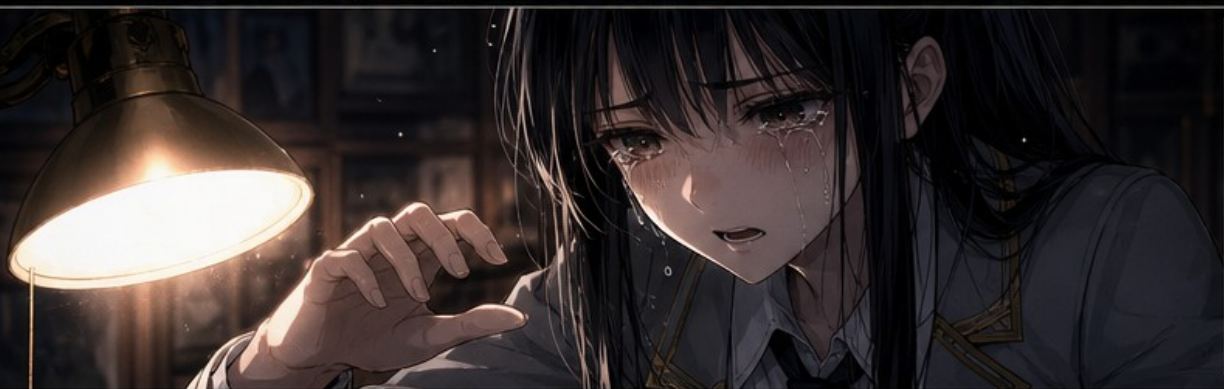
2.
THE PAST FLOODS IN—
NOT A MOMENT,
BUT A SEQUENCE.
A SIGNATURE.
A STAMP.
A ROOM FULL OF PEOPLE
WHO DO NOT KNOW
THEY ARE WITNESSING
AN ERASURE.



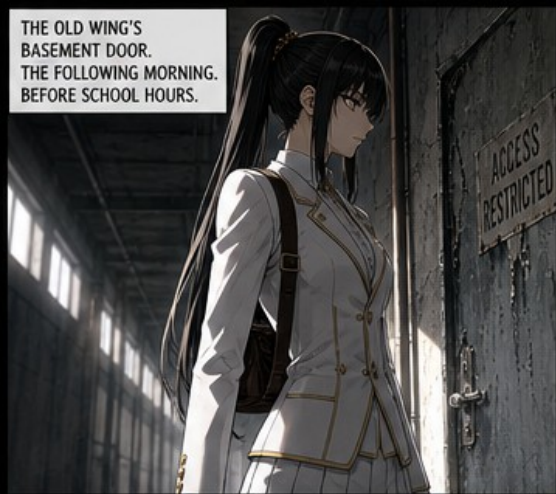
3.
HER BREATH
COMES RAGGED.
THE VISION'S WEIGHT
BUCKLES HER
COMPOSURE—
FOR THE FIRST TIME.



4.
SHE PULLS BACK.
GASPS.
THE LAMP LIGHT
SWIMMING BACK
INTO FOCUS—
HER FACE WET.
SHE IS CRYING.
SILENTLY.
WITHOUT HAVING
NOTICED SHE STARTED.



THE OLD WING'S
BASEMENT DOOR.
THE FOLLOWING MORNING.
BEFORE SCHOOL HOURS.



HE ALREADY KNOWS.



NOBODY HAD SAID THE WORD YET.
ALL THREE OF THEM WERE ALREADY
STANDING AT THE DOOR.

TO BE CONTINUED